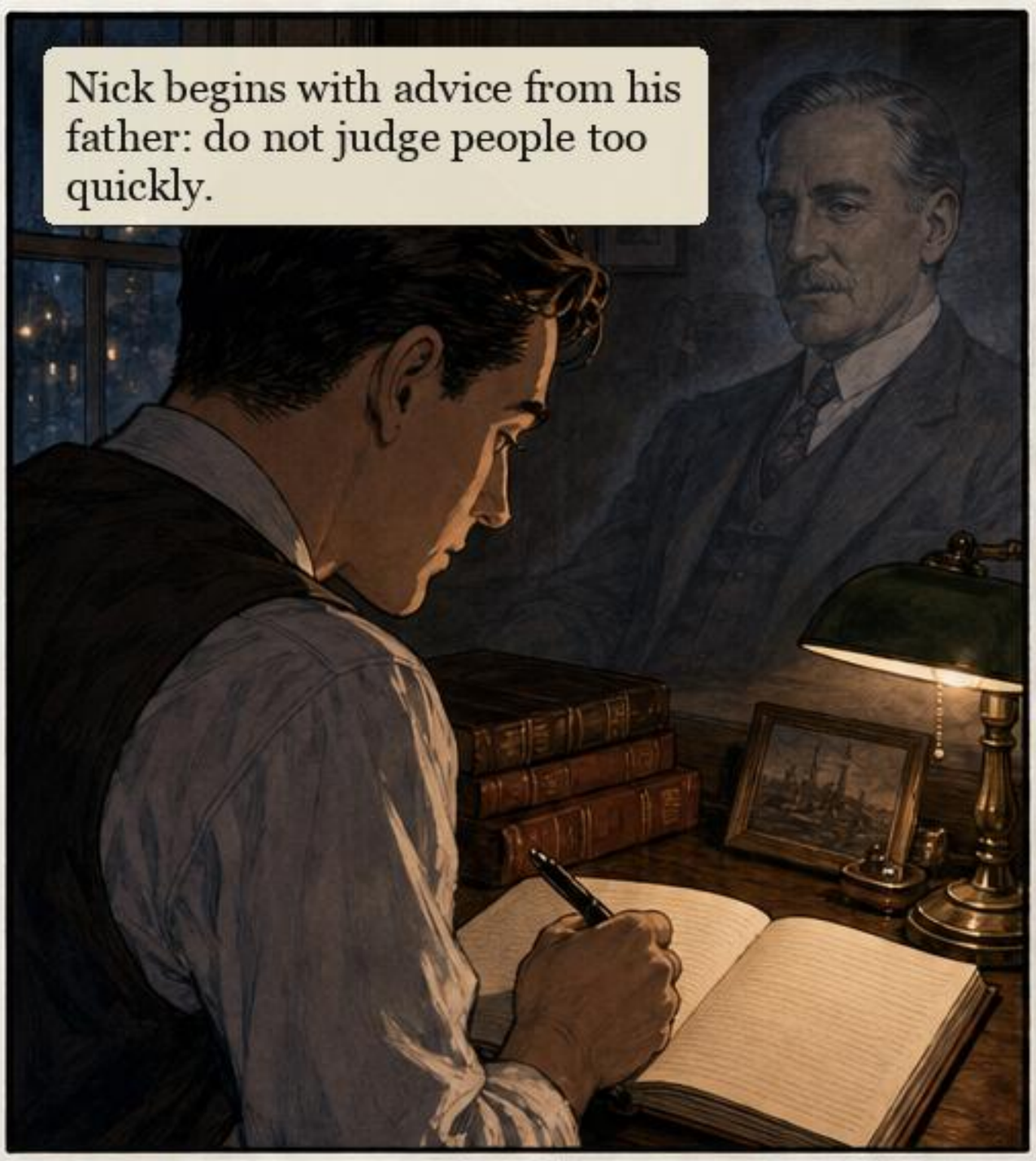

Nick begins with advice from his father: do not judge people too quickly.


Because of that advice, Nick learned to listen while other men told him their secrets.


Sometimes he tried to avoid those confessions, but he still believed judgment should be rare.


After his time in the East, Nick came home tired of moral chaos.


Only Gatsby escaped Nick's disgust, even though Gatsby stood for things Nick usually scorned.


What made Gatsby different was his extraordinary hope.


Nick believes Gatsby was not the problem; the corruption around Gatsby's dream was.


Before all this, Nick came from a well-to-do Midwestern family.


He went to Yale, served in the war, and came home restless.


In spring 1922, his father financed a year in the East so Nick could learn bonds.

Nick first planned to live near New York with a man from his office.

The coworker found an eighty-dollar bungalow, then was sent to Washington, leaving Nick alone.

Nick settled in with an old car, a short-lived dog, and a Finnish housekeeper.

How do you get to West Egg village?

For a day or two he felt lonely, until a newer arrival stopped him on the road.

Nick gave directions, and at once he felt less like a stranger.

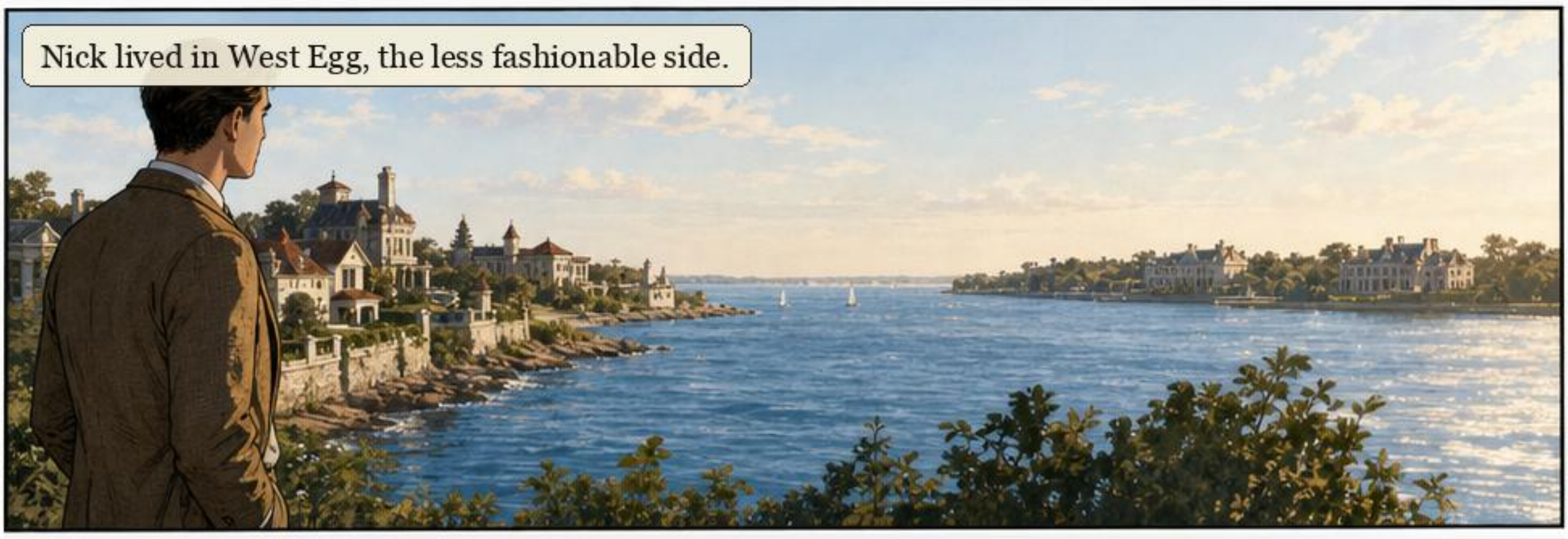
He joked to himself that he had become a guide and a pathfinder.

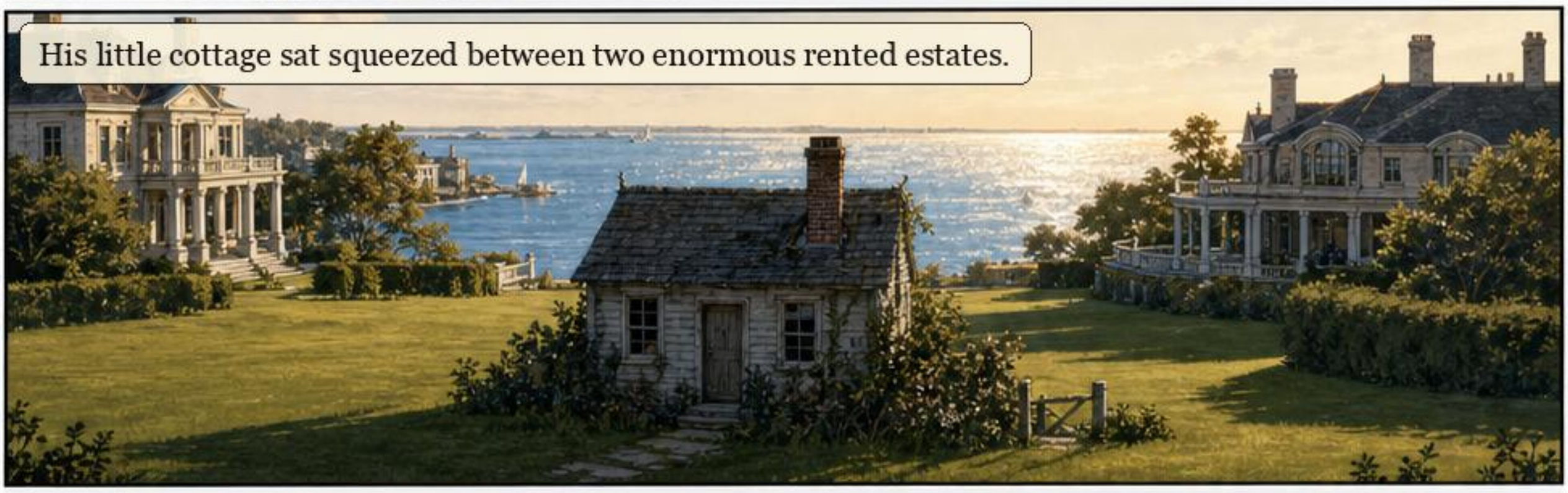
With summer beginning, the neighborhood started to feel open to him.

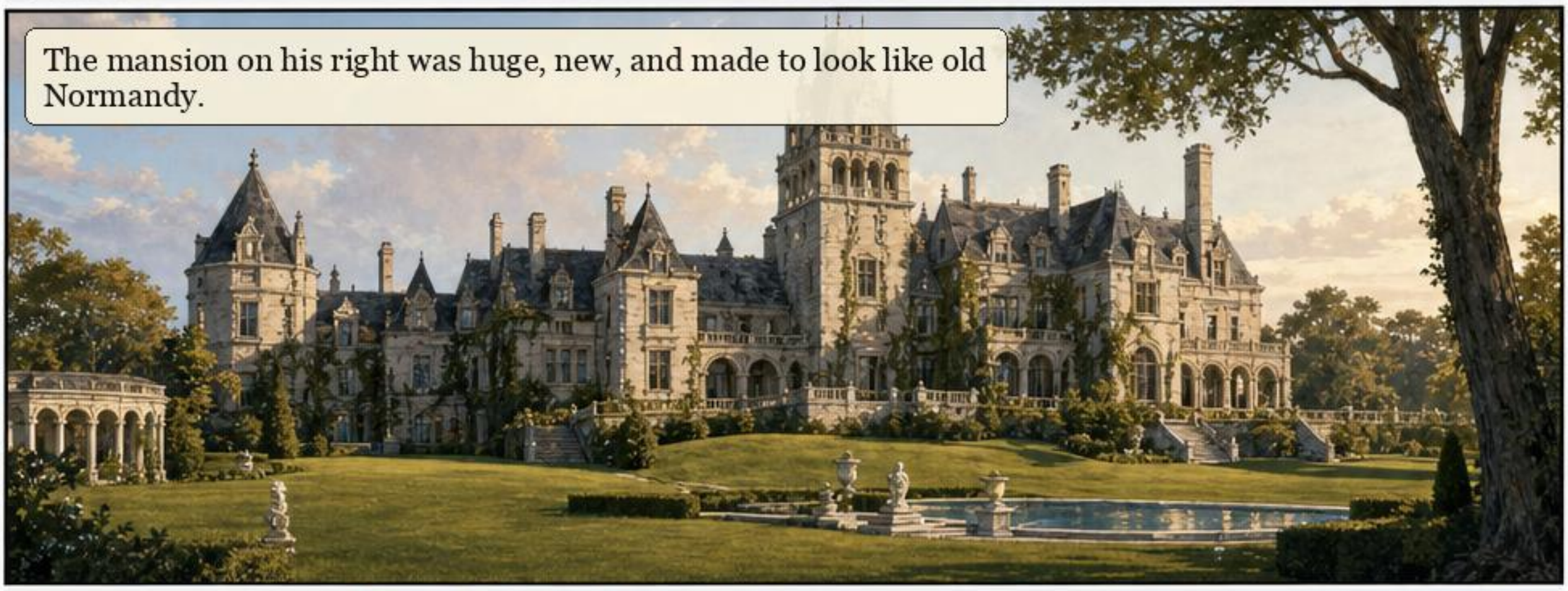
He bought books on banking and credit, hoping to master his new work.

He also wanted to rebuild the wider, more literary life he had once imagined.

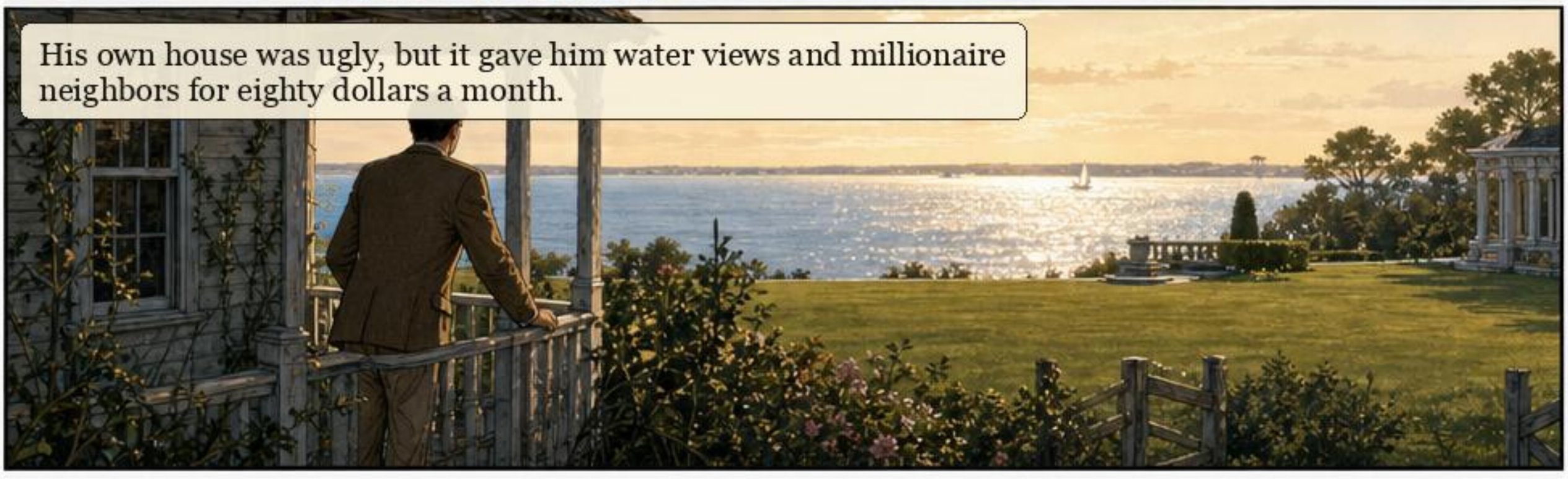
From the shore, Nick began to understand the two Eggs across the bay.


Nick lived in West Egg, the less fashionable side.


His little cottage sat squeezed between two enormous rented estates.


The mansion on his right was huge, new, and made to look like old Normandy.


Nick knew only that this was Gatsby's mansion.


His own house was ugly, but it gave him water views and millionaire neighbors for eighty dollars a month.